

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

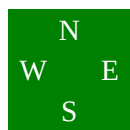
♠ Q 9 8 2
♥ 5 3 2
♦ A 9
♣ 8 7 6 4

♠ K 4

♥ A 7 4

♦ K 10 7 4

♣ A Q J 5



♠ J 10 6

♥ Q J 10 9 8

♦ 8 6 3

♣ K 2

♠ A 7 5 3

♥ K 6

♦ Q J 5 2

♣ 10 9 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North

another one from the ♣ suit as well. If you assume the ♣ finesse will fail, (and you have probably noticed that most finesses **DO** fail on these pages), that means you will lose the lead twice.

So what do you do about that ♥Q? Do you win or hold up?

You hold up, of course, to cut defensive communications when East has 5 ♥s and West has 3. East will probably play another ♥ to dummy's ♥K.

If both the ♦A and ♣K are in East's hand then you won't make this contract. He will easily establish his ♥s and have an entry to get in and cash them. If the ♦A is with East and the ♣K is with West then it doesn't matter in which order you play the suits since you will not lose the lead in ♣s. But if the ♣K is with East and the ♦A is with West then it is vital that you play ♣s first.

If you play on ♦s first, West will win the ♦A and play his last ♥, forcing out your ♥A. When East wins his ♣K he will cash 2 more ♥s.

But, if you finesse in ♣s first, East can win and establish the ♥ suit. But, when West wins the ♦A, he will have no ♥ to return.

With no 4-card Major suit you respond 2♦ to partner's Stayman bid. Partner now bids 2NT.

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With 17 points you naturally accept partner's invitation and bid 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥Q.

East's ♥Q lead presents you with an immediate decision (or two) to make.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 5

You need 4 additional winners and can only establish 3 of them in ♦s. So you will have to manufacture another one from the ♣ suit as well. If you assume the ♣ finesse will fail, (and you have probably noticed that most finesses **DO** fail on these pages), that means you will lose the lead twice.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A K 7 3
♥ K J 8 2
♦ A Q J
♣ 9 8

♠ Q 6 2

♥ Q 6 5

♦ 10 9 3

♣ J 7 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 5

♥ A 9 7 3

♦ K 6 4

♣ A K 6 2

♠ 10 9 8 4

♥ 10 4

♦ 8 7 5 2

♣ Q 10 3

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♥	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

6♥ by East

you should use Stayman, so you bid 2♣. Partner bids 2♥. Now what do say next?

You might just go ahead and bid 6♥. Partner probably has at least one Ace for his 1NT opening. The other choice is a Blackwood 4NT, and while you don't like to use Blackwood when you have a worthless doubleton, this bid will at least keep you out of slam if partner has ZERO Aces. You bid 4NT and partner replies 5♥. Next?

He has two Aces so you bid 6♥ because you know there aren't enough points for seven.

The contract would be 6♥ played by West.

East plays 6♥. South leads the ♠10.

You toy with the idea of letting this ride to your ♠J, then you put away your childish toys and play the ♠A from dummy.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 3

The two ♣ losers can be ruffed in dummy. A successful ♥ finesse could save you a loser in trumps. So, should you take the ♥ finesse now?

No, because if you play ♥A, then the ♥ finesse **LOSES**, North might play a third ♥ and stop you from your two ruffs in dummy. A much better plan is to play the ♥K, then ♥A, and if the ♥Q drops, well and good. This time she doesn't, but both North and South follow to both trump leads. Play the ♣ A K, the ♠ K, and the ♦ A K Q.

If somebody ruffs any of these it will be with the master trump and you won't care. But if they don't ruff yet, you just start cross-ruffing ♣s and ♠s and let them ruff in whenever they like.

Missing 5 trumps to the Queen the correct play to avoid a loser is to finesse.

But that is only correct as far as that suit is concerned. When you look at the entire hand you may find that by taking your two high trumps and leaving the master Queen out you can make all four of your small ones

Did you consider bidding 6NT? You are balanced, and the points are right. But with two 4-card Majors you should use Stayman, so you bid 2♣. Partner bids 2♥. Now what do say next?

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Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 2
♥ A 5 2
♦ Q J 10 6 4
♣ 10 9

♠ A 7 5

♥ K 9 6 3

♦ A K 8

♣ Q 5 3



♠ K Q J 9 6 3

♥ 8

♦ 9 3

♣ A J 8 7

♠ 4

♥ Q J 10 7 4

♦ 7 5 2

♣ K 6 4 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

2♠

2NT

Pass

3♣

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by South